

SPRINGFIELD POLICE DEPARTMENT

INCIDENT / ACCIDENT REPORT

Report Number	SPD-2023-09-4821
Incident Type	Personal Injury — Fall on Property
Date of Incident	September 12, 2023
Time of Incident	Approximately 14:15 hours (2:15 PM)
Day of Week	Tuesday
Date of Report	September 12, 2023
Reporting Officer	Officer Daniel Reyes, Badge #2847
Assisting Officer	Officer Maria Santos, Badge #3102

LOCATION OF INCIDENT

Address	1500 Lakeside Drive, Building C — Exterior Staircase
City, State, ZIP	Springfield, IL 62704
Property Type	Multi-unit residential apartment complex
Property Name	Lakeside Apartments
Property Owner	Lakeside Property Management, LLC
Property Manager	Mark Torres (on-site manager)

INVOLVED PERSONS

Injured Party

Name	Margaret Louise Wilson
Date of Birth	06/22/1961
Age	62
Sex	Female
Race	White
Address	2200 Oak Park Avenue, Apt 2B, Springfield, IL 62704
Phone	(217) 555-0288

Injury Description	Right hip injury — suspected fracture
Transported To	Springfield General Hospital via SFD Ambulance Medic 7
Relationship to Location	Visitor (daughter is tenant in Unit C-204)

Witness #1

Name	Diane Marie Farmer
Date of Birth	11/03/1985
Address	1500 Lakeside Drive, Unit C-108, Springfield, IL 62704
Phone	(217) 555-0341
Relationship	Tenant / eyewitness
Statement Taken	Yes — see Witness Statements below

Witness #2

Name	Thomas James Clark
Date of Birth	04/17/1972
Address	1500 Lakeside Drive, Unit C-112, Springfield, IL 62704
Phone	(217) 555-0392
Relationship	Tenant / arrived immediately after fall
Statement Taken	Yes — see Witness Statements below

Property Representative

Name	Mark Anthony Torres
Title	On-Site Property Manager
Employer	Lakeside Property Management, LLC
Phone	(217) 555-0500
Statement Taken	Yes — see Witness Statements below

NARRATIVE

On September 12, 2023, at approximately 14:32 hours, I (Officer Reyes) and Officer Santos responded to a report of a person down at 1500 Lakeside Drive, Building C. Springfield Fire Department Medic 7 was already on scene upon our arrival at 14:38 hours.

Upon arrival, I observed an adult female (later identified as Margaret Wilson) lying on the concrete landing at the base of the Building C exterior staircase. SFD paramedics were actively providing medical care. The patient was conscious, alert, and reporting severe right hip pain. Her right leg appeared shortened and externally rotated. The patient was immobilized on a backboard and long spine board as a precaution.

I observed a metal handrailing on the right side of the staircase (as viewed from the top) that was detached from the building wall at the upper mounting point. The railing was hanging loosely and swinging from its lower mounting bracket. The upper mounting plate and two anchor bolts were still attached to the railing end — the bolts had pulled free from the brick mortar. Visible corrosion was present on the exposed bolt surfaces and mounting plate.

I photographed the scene, including:

- Photo 1-3: Overview of the staircase and landing area
- Photo 4-6: Detached railing, close-up of failed anchor point
- Photo 7-8: Corroded anchor bolts still attached to mounting plate
- Photo 9: Lower mounting bracket (still attached to wall but visibly corroded)
- Photo 10-11: Concrete landing where patient was found
- Photo 12: Overview of Building C exterior

The staircase has 12 steps with a total height of approximately 8 feet from the top landing to the bottom concrete pad. The railing was located on the right side only. There was no railing on the left side of the staircase. I noted that three of the twelve steps were missing anti-slip treads.

I spoke with the property manager, Mark Torres, who arrived at approximately 14:45 hours. Torres stated he was aware of previous maintenance requests regarding the railing but that the repair had been scheduled for the fall maintenance cycle. Torres was unable to provide documentation of the maintenance requests at the scene.

The patient was transported to Springfield General Hospital by SFD Medic 7 at approximately 14:55 hours.

I referred the matter to Springfield Code Enforcement for inspection of the staircase and compliance with building codes. Code Enforcement Inspector Thomas Grant was notified.

WITNESS STATEMENTS

Statement of Diane Farmer (Witness #1)

Taken at scene, 14:50 hours, by Officer Reyes.

"I was coming out of my apartment on the first floor — I'm in C-108, right by the bottom of those stairs. I heard a loud noise, like metal scraping, and then a scream and a thud. I looked out my door and saw the older lady on the ground at the bottom of the stairs. The railing was hanging off the wall, swinging. She was holding her right side and crying. I called 911 right away. I've complained about that railing myself — well, not me personally, but I know other people in the building have. It's been wobbly for months."

Statement of Thomas Clark (Witness #2)

Taken at scene, 14:55 hours, by Officer Santos.

"I was in my apartment in C-112 and heard someone scream. I went outside and saw a woman lying at the bottom of the stairs. Another lady — I think it was Diane from 108 — was already there on the phone with 911. I could see the railing was broken off. I've lived here three years and I know that railing has been bad for a while. I personally submitted a maintenance request about it back in late August. Nothing was ever done."

Statement of Mark Torres (Property Manager)

Taken at scene, 15:05 hours, by Officer Reyes.

"I'm the on-site property manager for Lakeside Apartments. I was notified by my office that there was an incident at Building C. I arrived as quickly as I could. I am aware that we received maintenance requests about the Building C staircase railing. The repair was scheduled as part of our fall exterior maintenance program. I don't have the specific request numbers with me right now but I can provide them to you later. We have multiple buildings and the railing repair was not flagged as an emergency at the time."

EVIDENCE COLLECTED

Item #	Description	Disposition
1	Digital photographs (12 images)	Stored in SPD digital evidence system
2	Two corroded anchor bolts recovered from landing	Placed in evidence bag, booked into property
3	Mounting plate fragment	Placed in evidence bag, booked into property

NOTIFICATIONS AND REFERRALS

Agency	Contact	Date/Time	Purpose
Springfield Fire Department	Medic 7, Captain Rivera	09/12/2023, 14:22	Medical response (called by witness)
Springfield Code Enforcement	Inspector Thomas Grant	09/12/2023, 15:15	Building code inspection referral
SPD Records Division	—	09/12/2023, 17:00	Report filed

OFFICER ASSESSMENT

Based on my observations and witness statements, this incident appears to be a premises liability matter involving failure to maintain a structural safety feature (staircase handrailing) at a multi-unit residential property. The railing failure appears to be the result of long-term corrosion of the anchor bolts securing the railing to the exterior brick wall.

Two tenants (Farmer and Clark) independently stated that the railing condition had been known and reported to management prior to the incident. The property manager (Torres) confirmed awareness of prior maintenance requests but indicated the repair had not been prioritized.

This report has been referred to Code Enforcement for further investigation of building code compliance. No criminal charges are contemplated at this time. This matter appears to be a civil liability issue.

Report Completed By	Officer Daniel Reyes, Badge #2847
Report Date	September 12, 2023
Report Time	17:30 hours
Supervisor Review	Sgt. Patricia Hoffman, Badge #1204
Review Date	September 13, 2023
Case Status	Closed — Referred to Code Enforcement
Distribution	Records, Code Enforcement, Risk Management